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TERMS OF REFERENCE (ToR)

FIRM-LEVEL CONSULTANCY FOR WEBSITE HOSTING, DOMAIN MANAGEMENT, MAINTENANCE, TECHNICAL SUPPORT, AND X (TWITTER) PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION MANAGEMENT FOR THE DEVELOPMENT PARTNERS GROUP (DPG) ETHIOPIA WEBSITE

GENERAL INFORMATION

Services/Work Description:	Firm-level consultancy for website, maintenance, security updates, feature support, and X Premium subscription management for the DPG Ethiopia communications platforms.
Project/Program Title:	Development Partners' Coordination and Effectiveness in Ethiopia – Development Partners Group (DPG) Pooled Fund Project, Phase VII
Post Title:	Consultancy for Website Maintenance, Technical Support, and X Subscription Management
Duty Station:	Home-based with periodic virtual meetings
Expected Places of Travel:	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
Duration:	Two-year maintenance and subscription management contract, renewable based on performance and need
Expected Start Date:	ASAP

I. BACKGROUND / PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The Development Partners Group (DPG) brings together 36 bilateral and multilateral development partners supporting Ethiopia's development agenda. The DPG Secretariat, hosted by UNDP Ethiopia, ensures coordination, communication, and technical assistance to sector working groups, Heads of Agencies, and the Ministry of Finance. As part of this mandate, the Secretariat manages all digital platforms that support development cooperation, information sharing, and partner engagement.

In 2023/24, the DPG public website was redeveloped using the WordPress Content Management System, and content management capacity has since been strengthened. Hosting for the website was transitioned to a local Ethiopian service provider, and the domain name has been renewed under an existing contract for the next 12 months.. Additionally, the DPG operates an active official X (formerly Twitter) account used to share updates with development partners and the public.

To streamline operations and improve efficiency, the DPG Secretariat seeks to procure a single firm capable of managing website maintenance, hosting coordination, domain management (starting after Year 1), technical troubleshooting, and X Premium subscription administration under one unified contract.



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II. SCOPE OF THE WORK

The selected firm will be responsible for maintaining the DPG website, administering the hosting arrangements with the current provider, and managing X Premium subscription tasks.

2.1 Website Maintenance and Technical Support

- Conduct regular WordPress updates
- Monitor security and mitigate vulnerabilities
- Troubleshoot issues
- Implement new features and UI/UX improvements
- Ensure browser & mobile responsiveness
- Maintain and verify SSL
- Ensure proper SEO and metadata
- Ensure backups and restoration capability
- Provide technical guidance as needed

2.2 Access & Ownership Provisions

- The **DPG Secretariat retains full Super Administrator ownership** of the website
- The vendor receives a restricted **Web Manager** role
- All new feature additions must be pre-approved by the DPG Secretariat

2.3 Training and Knowledge Transfer

- Provide CMS training for new Secretariat staff
- Provide training upon request by DPG member agencies

2.4 X (Twitter) Premium Subscription Management

The selected firm will manage administrative tasks related to the DPG Ethiopia X account (Premium subscription).

Responsibilities include:

- Purchasing and renewing the **X Premium subscription** on behalf of the DPG Secretariat
- Receiving reimbursement for subscription costs upon submission of supporting documents
- Coordinating with **X Support** in the event of:
 - Account verification issues
 - Billing problems
 - Technical interruptions
 - Subscription malfunction
- Ensuring uninterrupted subscription status throughout the 24-month contract
- Maintaining secure credential handling practices

2.5 Website Hosting and Domain Management

The selected firm will manage hosting and domain administration after the expiration of the current hosting/domain agreement, which is valid for the first 12 months of this TOR.

- Managing the renewal of the dpgethiopia.org domain name (or any official DPG domain/s), including timely payments and submission of invoices for reimbursement.
- Ensuring domain registration details remain under the ownership of the DPG Secretariat.



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- Maintaining updated DNS records, coordinating with the hosting provider to implement DNS changes when required.
- Ensuring domain-related services (such as nameservers, DNSSEC, and redirection settings) function properly.
- Monitoring expiry timelines and initiating renewals well in advance to avoid service interruptions.

Activation Timeline:

The website hosting and domain management responsibilities outlined in this section will begin by 1st April 2027, upon the expiry of the current hosting and domain management arrangements. During the first 12 months, the selected firm will focus on maintenance, security updates, technical support, and X Premium subscription management.

Important:

- The **DPG Secretariat retains full primary ownership** of the X account.
- The vendor is granted **manager/editor-level access only**.
- The vendor is **not responsible** for drafting posts, uploading content, designing visuals, or managing editorial functions.

III. EXPECTED OUTPUTS AND DELIVERABLES

No.	Deliverables / Outputs	Estimated duration to complete (working days)	Review and Approvals Required
1	Website maintenance & hosting/domain management plan	Within 10 days	DPG Secretariat
2	Continuous website maintenance & security	24 months	DPG Secretariat
3	Monthly analytics & reports	Monthly	DPG Secretariat
4	Feature updates & UI/UX improvements	As needed	DPG Secretariat
5	X Premium subscription maintained; vendor reimbursed	24 months	DPG Secretariat
6	Support with X platform issues	As needed	DPG Secretariat
7	Training sessions	As requested	DPG Secretariat
8	Hosting management begins	1 April 2027 onward	
9	Server monitoring & issue resolution	Continuous	DPG Secretariat
10	End-of-contract handover	Month 24	DPG Secretariat



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IV. INSTITUTIONAL ARRANGEMENT / REPORTING RELATIONSHIPS

- a. The DPG Secretariat/UNDP will oversee the contract.
- b. The vendor must maintain responsiveness via email and participate in virtual coordination meetings as needed.

V. METHODOLOGY

The firm will:

- Conduct an initial technical assessment
- Submit a website maintenance plan and subscription management outline
- Implement updates, security checks, and subscription renewals
- Activate hosting/domain management in Year 2
- Provide X Premium subscription management
- Respond to technical and account-related issues promptly
- Deliver documentation and final handover of all the WordPress and database files at contract end
- Provide training on an as-needed basis

VI. QUALIFICATIONS OF THE SUCCESSFUL FIRM

- Minimum of 5 years of experience in WordPress maintenance and technical support
- Proven experience in subscription management for digital platforms (e.g., X, Meta)
- Expertise in PHP, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Experience with SEO, analytics, and security monitoring
- Demonstrated ability to manage billing and reimbursements professionally
- English language proficiency
- Ability to provide rapid response troubleshooting

Team must include:

- Project Manager
- WordPress Developer
- Web Security Specialist
- Support/Training Specialist

a. **Functional Competencies:**

- Strong analytical and problem-solving skills, with the ability to assess technical issues rapidly and provide effective solutions.
- Demonstrated expertise in website administration, WordPress CMS management, security monitoring, and troubleshooting.
- Ability to manage third-party digital services such as X (Twitter) Premium subscriptions, including billing, renewals, and coordination with platform support teams.



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- Capacity to integrate diverse digital information (security updates, analytics, platform performance) into actionable recommendations for the DPG Secretariat.
- Strong understanding of digital security protocols, data protection, and safe credential management.
- Ability to plan, organize, and deliver maintenance activities in a timely and efficient manner.
- Demonstrated responsiveness and reliability in support service delivery to institutional clients.

b. Language and other skills:

- Excellent command of the English language, with the ability to communicate clearly and professionally in written and verbal form.
- Ability to communicate effectively with diverse stakeholders, including the DPG Secretariat, development partners, technical staff, and service providers.
- Strong computer skills, including full proficiency in WordPress, browser-based administrative interfaces, security tools, and common productivity applications (Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint) as well as online communication platforms.
- Ability to provide clear instructions and training to non-technical users on CMS operations and digital platform management.

c. Compliance of the UN Core Values:

- Demonstrates integrity by modelling the UN's values and ethical standards.
- Promotes the vision, mission, and strategic goals of the UN.
- Displays cultural, gender, religion, race, nationality and age sensitivity and adaptability.
- Treats all people fairly without favoritism.
- Fulfils all obligations to gender sensitivity and zero tolerance for sexual harassment.

VII. DELIVERABLES AND PAYMENT MILESTONES

Payments will be made every six (6) months across the 24-month period.

Payment Trache	Deliverables	Approval	%
1st Payment (Month 6)	First 6 months of maintenance, updates, X subscription, and reporting	DPG Secretariat	25%
2nd Payment (Month 12)	Continued, maintenance, subscription upkeep, mid-term report	DPG Secretariat	25%
3rd Payment (Month 18)	Ongoing updates, training delivered, subscription active	DPG Secretariat	25%
4th Payment (Month 24)	Final handover, backups, documentation, subscription renewal confirmation	DPG Secretariat	25%



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VIII. Criteria for Selecting the best Offer

Firms will be evaluated based on **Cumulative Analysis** as per the following considerations:

- **Responsive/compliant/acceptable**, and
- **Having received the highest score** out of a pre-determined set of weighted **technical** and **financial** criteria specific to this solicitation.

The weights assigned are as follows:

- **a. Technical Criteria weight: 70%**
- **b. Financial Criteria weight: 30%**

Criteria		Weight
Technical Competence (based on CV/Proposal)		70%, of which:
▪ Technical expertise (professional experience & knowledge of the areas of expertise requires to implement the assignment)		50%
▪ Educational background as per the ToR requirement		10%
▪ Understanding of the country/regional context		10%
Financial (Lower Offer/Offer*100)		30%
Total Score	Technical Score + Financial Score	

Managers may ask (ad hoc) for any other materials relevant to pre-assessing the relevance of their experience, such as reports, publications or other materials.

IX. Confidentiality and Proprietary Interests

- The firm shall not either during the term or after termination of the assignment, disclose any proprietary or confidential information related to the consultancy service without prior written consent. Proprietary interests on all materials and documents prepared by the consultants under the assignment shall become and remain properties of UNDP.